I have spent my entire academic career in the IIT ecosystem, and I have seen how the older IITs — Delhi, Bombay, Kanpur, Madras and Kharagpur — have evolved organically. Initially, they focused strongly on technology education and produced world-class engineering graduates. Today, their impact can be seen globally, including in Silicon Valley. Over time, these institutions expanded into social sciences, liberal sciences, medical sciences and management education. The impact of these programmes is clearly visible.

The technology curriculum itself has changed significantly. Earlier, students had a structured course load, but now there is much greater flexibility, allowing students to take courses across disciplines. A student from textile engineering, civil engineering, biotechnology or chemical engineering can now explore computer science, management and other areas while retaining the core expertise.

Another important aspect is collaboration. At IIT Delhi, I worked not only with colleagues from management but also with experts from computer science, mathematics, industrial engineering and humanities. When a problem requires a solution, technology does not belong to a single discipline. It is about solving the problem. A collaborative environment increases the possibility of creating more relevant and sustainable solutions. This kind of ecosystem is difficult for standalone B-schools to create.

I bring my experience and strengths, and we are working towards transforming our traditional MBA-focused model to programmes in emerging areas such as artificial intelligence. Currently, no IIM has a BS programme specifically focused on AI. The combination of a BS programme in AI and Business Analytics with a Tech MBA is a new direction.

We also plan to introduce a programme on Indian family businesses from the next academic year.



"We need to prepare ourselves for a possible reduction in high-quality placement opportunities"

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How was the placement season? What does the data tell us about the state of hiring? Also, is global hiring facing challenges because of geopolitical shifts?

It is a challenging period. Everyone acknowledges that. And I believe these challenges may continue for the next four to five years. However, many of these factors are beyond our control.

If we look at the broader economic environment and the role of businesses and business schools, India continues to have a significant advantage because it is a large market. There will always be demand for consumption of products and services. Businesses will continue to grow, global companies will continue to operate in India, and new businesses will emerge. Therefore, the demand for the right kind of talent will continue.

When it comes to placements, the current record is satisfactory. However, I am concerned that this performance may face pressure in the coming years. The impact could become more visible as technology adoption, particularly artificial intelligence, changes the nature of hiring.

For example, if large consulting firms such as McKinsey, AT Kearney and BCG reduce hiring because AI adoption changes the demand for consultants, it will affect leading management institutions. If such firms reduce recruitment significantly, the impact will be felt across campuses.

We need to prepare ourselves for a possible reduction in high-quality placement opportunities. One approach could be to redesign programmes to meet industry requirements.

That is why we are thinking about specialised courses and more focused programmes. Students may not always need to spend two years on campus to meet all learning requirements.

Professionals already in the workplace are looking for high-quality programmes, which is why we are also exploring different delivery models, including blended and hybrid formats.

The objective is to ensure that management education remains relevant and aligned with the changing needs of industry. BT

@szarabi